

Colton Spahmer

Network Engineer · NOC Technician

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Network engineer with seven-plus years across carrier and enterprise environments — Cisco IOS, BGP and OSPF, VLANs, Carrier Ethernet and WAN circuits, and RAD hardware. Currently in the NOC at FirstLight Fiber, triaging service-affecting events across a regional fiber footprint. Equally comfortable deep in a multi-vendor fault or acting as the primary technical contact translating one into a resolution plan.

EXPERIENCE

NOC Technician

07/2026 – Present

FirstLight Fiber — Victor, NY

- Monitor and triage network alarms across a regional fiber footprint, carrying service-affecting events through to resolution.
- Troubleshoot Carrier Ethernet, optical, and broadband faults on Ciena and Calix equipment.
- Coordinate maintenance windows and customer communication, confirming service restoration once work completes.
- Document incidents and hand off open faults with the context the next shift needs to continue without re-diagnosing.

Network Engineer

10/2023 – 11/2025

RAD Data Communications — Mahwah, NJ

- Integrated RAD hardware into multi-vendor environments alongside Ciena and Cisco equipment across 50–100+ client sites.
- Served as subject-matter expert for the Megaplex-4100 series and Megaplex-1, providing advanced configuration and support.
- Configured and supported ETX-205, ETX-203, ETX-205A, and legacy MP-2100 products, plus AirMux wireless solutions.
- Engineered and deployed Ethernet and WAN circuit solutions built to enterprise client requirements.
- Diagnosed outages and service-affecting issues, managing escalations to completion across a large client portfolio.
- Acted as primary technical liaison, collaborating with six-plus engineers on network planning, design, and deployment.

Repair Technician II

01/2022 – 10/2023

FirstLight Fiber — Victor, NY

- Investigated and diagnosed trouble calls across DSL, T1, Carrier Ethernet, and Internet services.
- Troubleshoot events and outages on IP routers, Ethernet switches, and Ciena, Telco, and Calix ONTs.
- Managed tickets from creation through escalation and resolution, and oversaw maintenance activities with customer communication throughout.

Technical Support Associate II

01/2021 – 01/2022

WyreStorm — Malta, NY

- Resolved service-affecting issues with HDBaseT products using Wireshark and remote diagnostic tooling.
- Advised installers on network configuration — multicast and IP scheme settings — and built lab environments to reproduce and document customer-reported bugs.
- Mentored new support staff and contributed to system design.

Programmer / Installer

01/2017 – 01/2020

Xssentials — Avon, NY · Smart home automation

- Installed and configured routers, switches, firewalls, WLCs, and servers; trained and supervised junior technicians on-site.
- Programmed Savant Systems equipment, universal remote controllers, WinPak access control, and Panasonic IP and digital phone systems.

After Hours Trouble Resolution Specialist II

01/2014 – 01/2015

EarthLink Business — Rochester, NY

- Resolved after-hours trouble calls: spanning tree, VLAN trunking, and firmware updates over FTP.
- Assessed issues independently and dispatched field technicians for on-site resolution.

EARLIER Database & Security Co-op, Wegmans Food Markets (2013) · Computer Technician, Albany Medical Center (2012) · Network Systems Technician, Questar III (2008)

EDUCATION

B.S., Information Security and Forensics

2012 – 2014

Rochester Institute of Technology — High Honors

A.S., Computer Information Systems

2010 – 2012

Hudson Valley Community College — Academic Honors

Network Essentials & Intro to Networking (Cisco-sponsored)

2019

Columbia-Greene Community College

SKILLS

Routing & switching

Cisco IOS · BGP · OSPF · VLANs · Spanning Tree · Multicast · TCP/IP · DNS · DHCP · LAN/WAN

Carrier & access

Carrier Ethernet · Ethernet/WAN circuits · T1/DSL · optical transport · Ciena · Calix and Telco ONTs

Vendor platforms

RAD ETX-205 / ETX-203 / ETX-205A · Megaplex-4100 · Megaplex-1 · MP-2100 · AirMux wireless

Systems & tools

Wireshark · VMware · Proxmox · Active Directory · Windows Server · Microsoft SQL Server · Oracle · Linux

Security

Cryptography & authentication · network security auditing · malware analysis principles · firewalls

BEYOND THE DAY JOB

I run a self-hosted Proxmox homelab and build agent systems that operate it — dashboards, job queues, and automation that does real work unattended. Off the clock: 3D modelling and printing, painting, sculpture, mosaics, and music production. Documented at colton.ink.